

P3: Post-Mortem Presentation

Overview

You will provide a 7-minute presentation outlining the final status of your project while completing a live demonstration, as well as an overview of what went well and a reflection on challenges and possible solutions. As this is a technical post-mortem, you should expect questions throughout and should plan content accordingly.

Specification

The presentation will be evaluated according to the following criteria.

Context

A clear and concise statement of the problem – that is, what need is there that the project intends to address – should be included as part of the presentation. Additionally, the presentation should include a brief, but informative, description of the project and how it will address the need / solve the problem posed.

Delivery

All props must be ready in advance. The presentation will be delivered in a professional, easy to understand, straightforward manner. Speakers should dress professionally (business casual or formal) in a manner commensurate with a technical talk. Intonation, concision, intelligibility, presentation flow, pacing, and media integration will be evaluated. Auditory and visual elements should match and be synchronized to enhance the presentation.

Project State

Students should cover all significant elements of the project's final state of development, including but not limited to all major features, modes, performance, and where applicable, the state of asset and AI development.

Demonstration

A demonstration of the project's final version and usability should be included in the presentation. It should clearly display the project's features, and other elements, including their completed functionality, in the final state of development. The demonstration should be a live, user-case demonstration – that is, someone should, on the spot (not recorded), be using the artifact in its final state.

Some research projects aim to produce knowledge that is not artifact-specific; in collaboration the project's faculty advisor and stakeholder, students or teams may discuss the state of the work in lieu of a demonstration of an artifact. The discussion should include, at a minimum, the background and prior work in the field, methods / procedures used in conducting the research, the findings at the current stage in the project, and a consideration of the implications of the work.

Successes

Presentations should include a description of major challenges that the team successfully tackled. Possible topics include communications and mechanisms thereof, source collaboration / versioning, task distribution, and/or any other major aspect of the development of the project over the semester. Descriptions should not merely be a listing but a detailed description – including what the challenge was, why things went well, at how the team overcame the challenge. Teams should address at least three successes in their presentations.

Challenges

Reflecting on how process could be improved is a critical element of the post-mortem process. The topics that might be covered in reflection are like those that might be considered when discussing what went well but will vary by team. In the same vein, these challenges should be discussed in detail – the challenge itself, why it difficult for the team, and how the team might resolve this sort of challenge in future work. Teams should address at least three such challenges in their presentations.

Overall Impression

Software, like all tools, have subjective qualities that must be considered. In addition to the above criteria and adherence to project requirements as outlined in the design prototype specification, presentations will be evaluated according to best judgement by evaluators based on industry experience. This criterion exists to provide guidance to teams what falls outside of other criteria when necessary.

Submissions

Teams will perform their presentations in live, and will submit a copy of any slides / props on Canvas.